

To Kill a Mockingbird

Comprehension—Part One

INSTRUCTIONS

Answer the following items with a well-structured paragraph.

An exemplar illustrating the *Standard of Excellence* has been provided for the first question.

CHAPTER 1 (7-19)

1. What is the function of relating the Finch family history at the outset of the novel?

By relating the Finch family history at the outset of the novel, author Harper Lee illustrates how society is changing. The narrator states that it “was customary for the [Finch] men [...] to remain on Simon’s homestead” (8), but Atticus and his brother both attend university and, rather than return to the land, pursue professions other than farming. This shows how family traditions are shifting, and suggests that Atticus is at the forefront of change in the small town of Maycomb, Alabama. The narrator also discusses how Simon Finch started the homestead with slaves, and how eventually the slaves were freed, revealing that society in general is beginning to accept people of colour as people. It is likely that To Kill a Mockingbird will continue to explore the societal evolution occurring at this time. By examining the past, the author equips the reader to better understand the present and, furthermore, predict future events in the novel.

2. How is a feeling of mystery established in the first chapter?
3. Explain the manner of narration.
4. Chapter 1 introduces the reader to Maycomb. What details establish the novel’s setting?
5. What attitudes seem prevalent as a result of elements of setting?
6. Contrast Dill’s family situation with the Finches’.

CHAPTER 2 (20-27)

7. What satirical points are made about education through Scout’s experiences in school?

CHAPTER 3 (27-36)

8. Cite examples of contrast in Jem and Scout.
9. Contrast Burris Ewell and Walter Cunningham.
10. What is the thematic significance of the advice Atticus gives Scout?

CHAPTER 4 (37-45)

11. What is learned about Jem and Scout from their diverse reactions to the knothole pennies?
12. What characteristics of children in general are revealed through the Boo Radley game? Why does Scout not enjoy the games as much as Jem and Dill?

CHAPTER 5 (46-54)

13. What functions does Miss Maudie Atkinson serve in the novel?

CHAPTER 6 (54-62)

14. How does author Harper Lee arouse curiosity and build suspense in Chapter 6?

CHAPTER 7 (62-68)

15. Why is it significant that Jem had been crying?

CHAPTER 8 (68-78)

16. How do people react to the fire at Miss Maudie's house?

17. What characteristics does Miss Maudie show following the fire?

CHAPTER 9 (79-93)

18. What can be deduced about the character of Atticus from his defense of Tom Robinson?

19. Contrast Aunt Alexandra and Atticus.

20. How does Atticus hope to prevent Jem and Scout from catching the disease of Maycomb?

CHAPTER 10 (93-103)

21. Explain the symbolic meaning of the mockingbird.

22. What are the effects of the chapter's main events on Atticus, Jem, and Scout?

CHAPTER 11 (103-116)

23. What causes Jem to strike out against Mrs. Dubose?

24. As the nature of Mrs. Dubose's affliction is discovered, what is learned about her character?

25. What does Jem gain from his experience with Mrs. Dubose?

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*Vocabulary—Part One***INSTRUCTIONS**

Choose ten of the following words. Determine (1) the definition, (2) a synonym, (3) an antonym, and (4) design a sentence for each of your ten choices.

Assuage, apothecary, chattel, tyrannical, morbid, profane, compel, scrawl, entailment, vexation, mortification, speculation, amiable, truant, judiciously, auspicious, sluggish, unanimous, dreary, scowl, quell, pursuit, inquisitive, quibble, ramshackle, meditative, perpetrate, ingenuous, guileless, provocation, evasion, feeble, inconspicuous, jubilant, bedecked, inaudible, propensity.

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Comprehension—Part Two

CHAPTER 12 (117-129)

1. What accounts for the changed relationship between Jem and Scout?
2. What insights do Jem and Scout gain from attending church with Calpurnia?

CHAPTER 13 (129-137)

3. What elements heighten the contrast between Atticus and Alexandra?

CHAPTER 14 (137-146)

4. Cite examples of prejudice and lack of human understanding.
5. In what way does Jem break the one remaining code of childhood?
6. What does Scout mean when she says she “fe[els] the starched walls of a pink cotton penitentiary closing in on [her]” (136)?

CHAPTER 15 (146-157)

7. Contrast the two groups of men Atticus faces.
8. Why does the group at the jail disperse after Scout’s talk?

CHAPTER 16 (158-168)

9. What does the turnout for the trial imply about human nature?
10. Why is Scout confused after overhearing remarks about Atticus’s defense of Tom Robinson?

CHAPTER 17 (168-181)

11. What devices does Harper Lee use to characterize the Ewells, especially Bob Ewell?

CHAPTER 19 (192-202)

12. What tragic racial situation is illustrated in this chapter? How does it apply to the theme?
13. Why is it significant that Dill should be the one to get sick in the courtroom?

CHAPTER 20 (202-208)

14. What thematically related insights do Scout and Dill receive outside the courtroom?
15. In reference to Dill, what pessimistic note does Dolphus Raymond cast? What is the implication of the remark?

CHAPTER 22 (214-219)

16. What finally forces Jem over the threshold toward adulthood? What symbolic incident occurs that testifies to Jem’s move toward adulthood?
17. What hope and what fear are expressed at the end of the chapter?

CHAPTER 23 (220-230)

18. Give Atticus’s interpretation of recent events.
19. Cite examples that demonstrate Jem’s continuing maturity.

CHAPTER 24 (230-240)

- 20. What is ironic about the missionary circle's conversation?
- 21. Why does Tom try to escape?
- 22. What insight is gained into Alexandra's character?

CHAPTER 25 (240-244)

- 23. Discuss the mockingbird symbol in relation to Tom Robinson.
- 24. How is the feeling of apprehension conveyed at the end of the chapter?

CHAPTER 26 (244-250)

- 25. What satirical points are made on the subject of education in Chapter 26?
- 26. Why is Jem unable to speak about the trial without becoming angered?

CHAPTER 27 (250-256)

- 27. What three incidents occur concerning Bob Ewell? What is revealed about Bob Ewell?
- 28. What comic incident is related in this chapter and what function does it serve in the novel?

CHAPTER 28 (257-269)

- 29. How does author Harper Lee build suspense in Chapter 27 and Chapter 28?
- 30. Discuss the attack and the events that follow.

CHAPTER 29 (269-273)

- 31. Discuss the credibility of Boo's defense of Jem and Scout.

CHAPTER 30 (273-279)

- 32. What insight is gained into Heck Tate's character?
- 33. What situation do both Atticus and Scout recognize?
- 34. Discuss Scout's comment about the mockingbird in relation to Boo Radley.

CHAPTER 31 (279-284)

- 35. How does Scout demonstrate sensitivity and compassion in Chapter 30 and Chapter 31?

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Haughty, prerogative, preface, penitentiary, resilient, affliction, succinct, budge, futility, aggregation, sideboard, subpoena, affluent, sullen, glean, gavel, ambidextrous, pantomime, exodus, subtlety, expunge, chiffarobe, calibre, relent, remorse, quiver, obscure, furtive, sprawl, apprehension, vocation, spurious, florid, garment, symptom, perforate, spasm, stolidly.